Topic 2 — Religious and Philosophical Traditions

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Six Schools of Indian Philosophy (Shad Darshana) | Vedic Philosophy | Buddhist Philosophy | Jain Philosophy | Bhakti Movement | Sufi Movement | Major Religious Traditions of India | Religious Beliefs and Cultural Heritage

Sources: NCERT Themes I–III, An Introduction to Indian Art (Class 11), UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025 **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs

- **Maha Kumbh** at Prayagraj ran from **13 January to 26 February 2025**, about **45** days.
- **Kumbh Mela** (कुंभ मेला) is on the UNESCO Intangible Heritage list from **2017**. It is not a tangible monument.

2.1 Six Schools of Indian Philosophy (Shad Darshana / षड्दर्शन)

A **darshana** is a view aimed at liberation. **Astika** schools accept the Veda as a valid pramana. **Nastika** schools reject Vedic infallibility. Nastika is not the same as modern atheist.

- Six Astika schools run as three pairs: Nyaya–Vaisheshika, Samkhya–Yoga, Mimamsa–Vedanta.
- The Nastika set is Charvaka, Buddhism and Jainism. Add Ajivika (**Makkhali Gosala**) [आजीवक - मक्खलि गोसाल] when options include fate/*niyati* (नियति).

Nyaya (न्याय)

Aksapada Gautama | Nyaya Sutras

- Nyaya is the school of **logic and epistemology**, not Buddhism.
- It accepts four pramanas (प्रमाण): **pratyaksha** (प्रत्यक्ष), **anumana** (अनुमान), **upamana** (उपमान), **shabda** (शब्द).
- It has **16 padarthas** (पदार्थ - categories of debate): pramana, prameya, samshaya, prayojana, drishtanta, siddhanta, avayava, tarka, nirnaya, vada, jalpa, vitanda, hetvabhasa, chala, jati, nigrahasthana.
- It complements Vaisheshika (logic + atomism).

Logic: This Gautama is **not** the Buddha. Kanada is **not** Nyaya.

Vaisheshika (वैशेषिक)

Kanada (Uluka) | Vaisheshika Sutras

- Vaisheshika teaches **atomism** (*paramanu* / परमाणु).
- It has seven padarthas (पदार्थ): dravya (द्रव्य), guna (गुण), karma (कर्म), samanya (सामान्य), vishesha (विशेष), samavaya (समवाय), **abhava** (अभाव).
- The nine dravyas are prithvi, jal, tejas, vayu, akasha, kala, dik, atman, manas.

Samkhya (सांख्य)

Kapila | Samkhya Karika (Ishvarakrishna)

- Samkhya is dualist: **Purusha** (पुरुष - consciousness) and **Prakriti (प्रकृति - matter).
- It has three gunas: sattva, rajas, tamas (सत्त्व, रजस्, तमस्). There are **25 tattvas** (तत्त्व: prakriti → mahat → ahamkara → 5 tanmatra + 5 mahabhuta + 5 jnanendriya + 5 karmendriya + manas + purusha).
- Classical Samkhya is **nirishvara** (निरीश्वरवाद - no God as a tattva). Liberation is viveka (विवेक ख्याति).

Yoga (योग)

Patanjali | Yoga Sutras

- According to Patanjali, Yoga is defined as *Yogash chitta-vritti-nirodhah* (योगश्चित्तवृत्तिनिरोधः — the cessation of mental fluctuations).
- Yoga is the practical partner of Samkhya. It adds **Ishvara** (ईश्वर).
- Ashtanga Yoga (अष्टांग योग), in order, is **yama** (यम), **niyama** (नियम), **asana** (आसन), **pranayama** (प्राणायाम), **pratyahara** (प्रत्याहार), **dharana** (धारणा), **dhyana** (ध्यान), **samadhi** (समाधि).
- Yama comprises ahimsa, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, aparigraha.
- Niyama comprises shaucha, santosha, tapas, svadhyaya, Ishvara-pranidhana.
- The goal is **kaivalya** (कैवल्य / मोक्ष), not modern gym-yoga.

Purva Mimamsa (पूर्व मीमांसा)

Jaimini | Mimamsa Sutras

- Purva Mimamsa interprets Vedic **ritual** (karma-kāṇḍa / कर्मकाण्ड). The Veda is *apaurusheya* (अपौरुषेय).
- Dharma is the correct performance of sacrifice.
- The sub-schools are **Kumarila Bhatta** and **Prabhakara**. Kumarila is a trap option in *Milind Panho* questions (he is Mimamsa, not Buddhist).

Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta / उत्तर मीमांसा - वेदांत)

Badarayana / Vyasa | Brahma Sutras

- Vedanta interprets the Upanishads (jñāna-kāṇḍa / ज्ञानकाण्ड).
- The **Prasthanatrayi** (प्रस्थानत्रयी) are the Upanishads, the *Bhagavad Gita* (भगवद्गीता) and the Brahma Sutras.
- The founder is not Kapila.

Advaita — Shankara (अद्वैतवाद - शंकराचार्य)

8th century | Advaita | Brahman real, world mithya

- Shankara's guru is **Govinda**. His paramguru is **Gaudapada**. His text is *Brahma-sutra-bhashya*.
- **Sringeri** is the southern matha. It is linked with **Yajurveda** (यजुर्वेद) and **Sureshvara**.
- **Dwaraka** is the western matha. It is linked with **Samaveda** (सामवेद) and **Hastamalaka**.
- **Puri / Govardhana** is the eastern matha. It is linked with **Rigveda** (ऋग्वेद) and **Padmapada**.
- **Jyotirmath / Badrinath** is the northern matha. It is linked with **Atharvaveda** (अथर्ववेद) and **Totaka**.

Vishishtadvaita — Ramanuja (विशिष्टद्वैतवाद - रामानुजाचार्य)

11th–12th century | Sriperumbudur | Sri Bhashya

- Ramanuja taught qualified non-dualism: Brahman with attributes. He belongs to the Sri Vaishnava line of **Yamunacharya** and teaches Prapatti (प्रपत्ति - surrender). He also wrote *Vedartha Sangraha* and *Gita Bhashya*.

Dvaita — Madhva (Madhavacharya) [द्वैतवाद - मध्वाचार्य]

13th century | Udupi | Purna Prajna / Anandatirtha

- God, soul and world are eternally distinct. Madhva's centre has eight Udupi mathas (Ashta Mathas). The Krishna image comes from the Dwaraka tradition.

Dvaitadvaita — Nimbarka (द्वैताद्वैतवाद - निम्बार्काचार्य)

Doctrine: Bhedabheda (भेदाभेद - difference-and-non-difference)

- Nimbarka's path is Radha–Krishna worship. It is the Mathura–Salvadri / Nimbaraka sampradaya (Sanakadi).

Shuddhadvaita — Vallabhacharya (शुद्धाद्वैतवाद - वल्लभाचार्य)

15th–16th century | Champaranya | Pushtimarg

- Vallabha taught pure non-dualism. He is the guru of **Surdas** (सूरदास). The Ashtachhap poets of Braj include Surdas, Kumbhan, Parmanand, Krishna Das, and others.

Charvaka / Lokayata (चार्वाक / लोकायत)

Brihaspati (traditional founder) | Nastika

- Only **perception** is pramana. Charvaka accepts four bhutas (no akasha). It rejects karma, afterlife, and the Veda.

Ajivika (आजीवक)

Makkhali Gosala | Ajivika | Nastika

- Ajivika teaches the doctrine of fate (*niyati* / नियति). Makkhali Gosala was a contemporary of the Buddha and Mahavira. The school later became extinct.

Pramana Count across Philosophical Systems

- **Charvaka** accepts **1** pramana — pratyaksha only.
- **Bauddha** (typical) accepts **2** — pratyaksha and anumana.
- **Samkhya / Yoga / Vaisheshika** accept **3** — pratyaksha, anumana, shabda.
- **Nyaya** accepts **4** — those three plus upamana.
- **Prabhakara Mimamsa** accepts **5** — adding arthapatti.
- **Kumarila Mimamsa / Vedanta** accept **6** — adding anupalabdhi (non-perception).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q30

Which of the following pairs (**School of Thought — Proponent**) is correctly matched?

A. Vaisheshika — Patanjali B. Mimansa — Kanada C. Nyaya — Gautama D. Uttara Mimansa — Kapila

Show answer

Ans: C — Nyaya–Gautama.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q33

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer.

List-I (Philosopher) A. Ramanuja B. Madhavacharya C. Nimbarka D. Vallabhacharya

List-II (Philosophy) 1. Shuddhadvaita 2. Dvaitadvaita 3. Dvaita 4. Vishishtadvaita

A. 2, 4, 1, 3 B. 3, 1, 4, 2 C. 1, 2, 3, 4 D. 4, 3, 2, 1

Show answer

Ans: D — 4, 3, 2, 1.

2.2 Vedic Philosophy

Shruti stack: Samhita → Brahmana → Aranyaka → Upanishad

- **Rigveda** is the oldest Veda. Its priest is the **Hotr**. Its Upaveda is Ayurveda.
- **Samaveda** is the Veda of melody. Its priest is the **Udgatr**. Its Upaveda is Gandharvaveda.
- **Yajurveda** is the Veda of ritual and its priest is the **Adhvaryu**. It has Shukla and Krishna recensions. Its Upaveda is Dhanurveda.
- **Atharvaveda** deals with spells and healing. Its Upaveda is Arthashastra / Shilpaveda in variant lists.
- The Rigveda has **10 mandalas** and about **1028** suktas.
- The Gayatri mantra is RV **3.62.10** (Vishvamitra). The Nasadiya hymn is the creation hymn of RV **10**.
- The four priests are Hotr (Rig), Udgatr (Sama), Adhvaryu (Yajur), and Brahman (Atharva / overall).
- The Rig Brahmanas are **Aitareya** and **Kaushitaki**.
- The Yajur Brahmanas are **Taittiriya** (तैत्तिरीय) and **Shatapatha** (Yajnavalkya).
- The Sama Brahmanas are **Panchavimsha / Tandya** and **Jaiminiya**.

- The Atharva Brahmana is **Gopatha** only.
- The six Vedangas are Shiksha, Kalpa, Vyakarana (**Panini** (पाणिनि)), Nirukta (**Yaska** (यास्क)), Chandas (**Pingala**), and Jyotisha.
- **Tat tvam asi** belongs to the **Chandogya** Upanishad.
- Aham Brahmasmi belongs to the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad.
- Ayam atma Brahma belongs to the Mandukya Upanishad.
- Prajnanam Brahma belongs to the Aitareya Upanishad.
- **Brahman** is ultimate reality — not **Brahmin** (varna). Related ideas are Atman, karma, samsara, and moksha.
- The Purusharthas are Dharma, Artha, Kama, and Moksha. The ashramas run Brahmacharya → Grihastha → Vanaprastha → Sannyasa.
- The Pancha-mahayajna are Brahma, Deva, Pitri, Bhuta, and Manushya.
- Sixteen samskaras run Garbhadhana to Antyeshti. **Upanayana** is the one (entry to Vedic study).
- Early Vedic gods include **Indra** (war/rain), **Agni**, **Varuna** (वरुण) (rta), Soma, and Ushas. The Trimurti (Brahma–Vishnu–Shiva) is **post-Vedic**.
- Major Smriti lawgivers include Manu, Yajnavalkya, Narada, and Parashara. Itihasa comprises Valmiki's Ramayana and Vyasa's Mahabharata. There are **18 Mahapuranas** (including the Bhagavata, Vishnu, Shiva, and Markandeya Puranas).

> **Logic:** Upanishads = jñāna-kāṇḍa = Vedanta. Brahmanas = karma-kāṇḍa. Rigveda = oldest.

2.3 Buddhist Philosophy

Siddhartha Gautama (Shakyamuni) | 563–483 BCE (traditional)

- The Buddha belonged to the Shakya clan. His father was **Suddhodana**, his mother **Maya**, his wife **Yashodhara**, and his son **Rahula**.
- His horse was **Kanthaka**. His charioteer was **Channa**.
- The four sights led to the Great Renunciation at **29**. Enlightenment came at **35** under the Bodhi tree.
- The first monk to understand the Sarnath sermon was **Kaundinya (Kondanna)**.
- His cousin **Devadatta** split the Sangha.
- **Ananda** was the attendant. **Upali** recites the Vinaya.
- **Sariputta** and **Moggallana** were the chief disciples.
- The Eightfold Path is grouped as **Prajna** (view, intention), **Sheel** (speech, action, livelihood), and **Samadhi** (effort, mindfulness, concentration).

Four great places

Birth: Lumbini (Nepal, Ashokan pillar) **Enlightenment:** Bodh Gaya (Bihar) **First sermon (Dharmachakrapravartana):** Sarnath / Isipatana, UP — Deer Park **Mahaparinirvana:** Kushinagar, UP (age 80)

- Other UP sites are Shravasti (Jetavana), Sankisa (descent), and Kaushambi.

Doctrine

Core: Four Noble Truths + Eightfold Path + Middle Path

- The Four Noble Truths are Dukkha, Samudaya (*tanha*), Nirodha, and Magga.
- The path is right view, intention, speech, action, livelihood, effort, mindfulness, and concentration.
- The five skandhas are rupa, vedana, samjna, samskara, and vijnana. **Pratityasamutpada** is the chain of **12** nidanas (dependent origination).
- The Buddhist Triratna is Buddha, Dharma, and Sangha.
- **Anicca** means impermanence. **Anatta** (अनात्मवाद) means no permanent self (not Upanishadic Atman, not Jain jiva).
- The Middle Path rejects both luxury and extreme tapas.
- Panchashila forbids killing, stealing, sexual misconduct, lying, and intoxicants.
- Nirvana is the extinction of craving, not a Vedic heaven.

Tripitaka

Canon: Vinaya + Sutta + Abhidhamma (Pali)

- Vinaya (rules) was recited by **Upali** at the first council. Sutta (discourses) was recited by **Ananda**. Abhidhamma was emphasised at the third council.

Buddhist literature

Milind Panho is a dialogue between King Milinda (Menander) and monk **Nagasena** — not Nagarjuna, not Kumarila.

- *Buddhacharita* (बुद्धचरित) and *Saundarananda* (सौंदरानंद) were written by **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) (Kanishka age).
- *Madhyamaka Karika* is by **Nagarjuna** (नागार्जुन) (*Shunyavada*).
- Asanga and Vasubandhu belong to Yogacara / Vijnanavada. Dignaga and Dharmakirti belong to logic (Nalanda).
- *Visuddhimagga* is by Buddhaghosa.
- Other texts are the Jataka, Dipavamsa and Mahavamsa, Divyavadana, Mahavastu, and Lalitavistara.

Sects

- **Theravada / Hinayana** holds the Arhat ideal, uses Pali, and spread in Sri Lanka–Myanmar–Thailand.
- **Mahayana** holds the Bodhisattva ideal (Avalokiteshvara / Padmapani, Manjushri, Maitreya, Tara, Vajrapani), uses Sanskrit, and spread in East Asia.
- **Vajrayana** (वज्रयान) is tantric. It is strong in Tibet, Bhutan, Ladakh, and Sikkim.
- Hinayana is a Mahayana label; papers still use it. The 2nd council split is Sthaviravada vs Mahasanghika. The 4th council is linked with Sarvastivada.

First Buddhist Council

The First Council sat at **Rajagriha** (Sattapanni). The patron was **Ajatashatru** (अजातशत्रु). The president was **Mahakassapa**. The traditional year is about **483 BCE**, just after the Mahaparinirvana.

- Vinaya and Sutta were recited. It was not at Vaishali and not under Ashoka.

Second Buddhist Council

The Second Council sat at **Vaishali** (वैशाली). The patron was **Kalasoka**. The traditional year is about **383 BCE**.

- It arose from a ten-point dispute. The Sangha split into Sthavira and Mahasanghika.

Third Buddhist Council

The Third Council sat at **Pataliputra** (पाटलिपुत्र). The patron was **Ashoka** (अशोक). The president was **Moggaliputta Tissa**. The traditional year is about **250 BCE**.

- It emphasised Abhidhamma / *Kathavatthu*. Missions went out, including Mahinda to Sri Lanka.

Fourth Buddhist Council

The Fourth Council sat at **Kundalvana** in Kashmir. The patron was **Kanishka** (कनिष्क). The president was **Vasumitra** (Ashvaghosha in some tradition). The date is about the first or second century CE.

- It produced Sarvastivada commentaries and a Mahayana push. Theravada also counts a Sri Lankan 4th council — if the paper says Kashmir/Kanishka, use this one.
- Buddhist symbols include the dharmachakra, Bodhi tree, footprints, deer (Sarnath), and the lion capital (national emblem).
- Buddhism spread under Ashoka. It then grew under Kanishka / Gandhara. Later it was backed by the Palas and by Nalanda–Vikramashila.
- It declined in the plains after the **12th–13th** c.
- In the modern era, **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** revived Navayana Buddhism, formally embracing the faith at Nagpur on **14 October 1956**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q105

The four Buddhist Councils were held at the following places. Arrange them in correct chronological order and select the correct answer from the code given below.

1. Vaishali
2. Rajagriha
3. Kundalvana
4. Pataliputra

A. 1, 2, 4, 3 B. 2, 1, 3, 4 C. 2, 1, 4, 3 D. 1, 2, 3, 4

Show answer

Ans: C — Rajagriha → Vaishali → Pataliputra → Kundalvana.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q24

Milind Panho is in the form of a dialogue between King Milind and a Buddhist saint. The concerned saint was—

A. Nagarjun B. Nagbhatt C. Nagasena D. Kumaril Bhatt

Show answer

Ans: C — Nagasena.

2.4 Jain Philosophy

Frame: 24 Tirthankaras in this cycle. Not founded by Mahavira.

- **Rishabhanatha / Adinatha** is the **1st** Tirthankara. Parshvanatha is the **23rd** (the earlier historical figure). **Mahavira Vardhamana** is the **24th**.
- Neminatha (**22nd**) is Krishna's cousin in Jain lore.

Mahavira

Kundagrama (Vaishali region) | nirvana at Pavapuri, Bihar

- His parents were Siddhartha and Trishala (Licchavi), and he was a contemporary of the Buddha. Kevala came at Jrimbhikagrama / Rijupalika. The first sermon was at Vipulachala (Rajgir).
- He had **11 ganadharas**. The chief was **Indrabhuti Gautama**.
- His symbol is the **lion**.
- Digambara says he never married. Svetambara says he married Yashoda and had a daughter Priyadarshana.

Doctrine

Triratna: Samyak Darshan, Jnana, Charitra — not Buddha–Dharma–Sangha.

- **Parshvanatha's four vows** are ahimsa, satya, asteya, and aparigraha. **Mahavira added the fifth — brahmacharya** (so five Mahavratas).
- The Mahavratas are ahimsa, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, and aparigraha. Laity take anuvratas. **Sallekhana** is the holy fast unto death.
- The five **Kalyanakas** of a Tirthankara are Chyavana (conception), Janma (birth), Diksha (renunciation), Kevala Jnana, and Nirvana.
- Jain metaphysics splits jiva (soul) from ajiva (pudgala, dharma, adharma, akasha, kala). Karma is **subtle matter** on the jiva.
- The five jnanas are mati, shruta, avadhi, manahparyaya, and **kevala**.
- **Anekantavada** is many-sided truth. **Syadvada** is seven *bhangas* and **Nayavada** is standpoints. The Middle Path is **Buddhist**, not Jain.
- The Jain symbol is an open palm with an *ahimsa* wheel. The swastika in Jain use is auspicious (four gatis).

Twenty-four Tirthankaras

Candidates should master the serial order, name, and emblem (*lanchhan*) of each Tirthankara. **Twenty** Tirthankaras attained Nirvana at **Sammed Shikhar** (सम्मेद शिखर) (Parasnath, Jharkhand), with only **four**

exceptions (Rishabhanatha at Mount Ashtapad, Vasupujya at Champapuri, Neminatha at Mount Girnar, and Mahavira at Pavapuri).

- 1 **Rishabhanatha / Adinatha** is the first Tirthankara. His emblem is the **bull** and nirvana is at **Ashtapad / Kailash**. His son is **Bahubali** (Gomateshwara); birth is in the Ayodhya tradition and colour is golden.
- 2 **Ajitanatha** is the second Tirthankara. His emblem is the elephant. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 3 **Sambhavanatha** is the third Tirthankara. His emblem is the horse. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 4 **Abhinandananatha** is the fourth Tirthankara. His emblem is the monkey. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 5 **Sumatinatha** is the fifth Tirthankara. His emblem is the curlew / heron. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 6 **Padmaprabha** is the sixth Tirthankara. His emblem is the lotus. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar and colour is **red**.
- 7 **Suparshvanatha** is the seventh Tirthankara. His emblem is the swastika. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 8 **Chandraprabha** is the eighth Tirthankara. His emblem is the crescent moon. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar and colour is **white**.
- 9 **Pushpadanta / Suvidhinatha** is the ninth Tirthankara. His emblem is the crocodile / makara. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 10 **Shitalanatha** is the tenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the shrivatsa / wishing-tree. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 11 **Shreyansanatha** is the eleventh Tirthankara. His emblem is the rhinoceros. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 12 **Vasupujya** is the twelfth Tirthankara. His emblem is the buffalo and nirvana is at **Champapuri / Champa Nagri (Bhagalpur)** — **not** Sammed Shikhar. Colour is red, and all five Kalyanakas are at Champa in the Svetambara telling.
- 13 **Vimalanatha** is the thirteenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the boar. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 14 **Anantanatha** is the fourteenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the falcon / hawk (some lists bear). Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 15 **Dharmanatha** is the fifteenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the vajra. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 16 **Shantinatha** is the sixteenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the deer / antelope. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 17 **Kunthunatha** is the seventeenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the goat. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 18 **Aranatha** is the eighteenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the fish / nandyavarta. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 19 **Mallinatha** is the nineteenth Tirthankara. His emblem is the water-pot / kalasha. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar, colour is **blue**, and only Svetambara describes this Tirthankara as female (Digambara: male).
- 20 **Munisuvrata** is the twentieth Tirthankara. His emblem is the tortoise. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar and colour is **black**.

- 21 **Naminatha** is the twenty-first Tirthankara. His emblem is the blue lotus. Nirvana is at Sammed Shikhar.
- 22 **Neminatha / Arishtanemi** is the twenty-second Tirthankara. His emblem is the **conch**. Nirvana is at **Urjayanta / Girnar / Raivatgiri (Gujarat)**. He is Krishna's cousin in Jain lore and colour is black.
- 23 **Parshvanatha** (पार्श्वनाथ) is the twenty-third Tirthankara. His emblem is the **snake**. Nirvana is at **Sammed Shikhar**. He is historical (~**9th–8th** c. BCE), colour is green/blue, and he taught four vows (no brahmacharya yet).
- 24 **Mahavira / Vardhamana** is the twenty-fourth Tirthankara. His emblem is the **lion**. Nirvana is at **Pavapuri**. Colour is golden, and he is the last of this cycle.

> **Logic:** Memorise **all 24 name–symbol** pairs. Nirvana exceptions = **Rishabha (Ashtapad), Vasupujya (Champapuri), Nemi (Girnar), Mahavira (Pavapuri)**. **Vasupujya–Sammed Shikhar** is the classic wrong pair — his nirvana is **Champapuri**.

Digambara

Dress: sky-clad (nude monks)

- Digambara holds that women cannot attain moksha in a female birth. Original Angas are said to be lost and images are unadorned. The sect is strong in Karnataka, MP, and Bundelkhand.

Svetambara

Dress: white robes

- Svetambara holds that women may become nuns (*sadhvi*) and attain moksha. Twelve Angas survive and the sect is strong in Gujarat and Rajasthan. The Vallabhi council under **Devardhigani** compiled the canon.
- An earlier council is Pataliputra / **Sthulabhadra** (Bhadrabahu led the southern migration in the Chandragupta Maurya famine story). Yapaniya is an extinct in-between sect.
- The **Twelve Angas** (Svetambara) are Acharanga, Sutrakritanga, Sthananga, Samavayanga, Bhagavati (Vyakhyaprajnapti), Jnatadharmakatha, Upasakadasha, Antakriddasha, Anuttaraupapatikadasha, Prashnavyakarana, Vipaka, and **Drishtivada** (lost).
- **Kalpasutra** (Bhadrabahu) narrates the lives of Tirthankaras. It is recited at **Paryushana**.
- *Tattvartha Sutra* (Umasvati) is accepted by both sects.
- Hemachandra wrote *Parishishtaparvan*.
- **Gomateshwara / Bahubali** stands at Shravanabelagola. It was commissioned by **Chamundaraya** in **981 CE** under the Western Ganga.
- Other Jain sites are Dilwara (Abu), Palitana (Shatrunjaya), and Ranakpur.
- **Mathura Kankali Tila** has Jain remains in **Uttar Pradesh.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q131

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched? (Tirthankar) — (Nirvan Place)

A. Rishabhanath — Ashtapad B. Vasupujya — Sammedashikhar C. Neminath — Urjayanta D. Mahavira — Pavapuri

Show answer

Ans: B — Vasupujya = Champapuri.

2.5 Bhakti Movement

Bhakti is personal devotion. It uses the vernacular, singing, and a guru. It opens the path beyond a ritual caste monopoly.

- **Saguna** is God with form (Rama, Krishna). **Nirguna** is the formless Absolute (Kabir, Nanak strain).
- Bhakti arose first in the South (**6th–9th** c.), then Maharashtra, then the north.
- The four Vaishnava sampradayas are **Sri** (Ramanuja), **Brahma** (Madhva), **Rudra** (Vallabha), and **Sanakadi / Nimbarka**.

Alvars

There are **12 Alvars**. They are Vaishnava poet-saints of Vishnu. Their corpus is the *Nalayira Divya Prabandham* (नालायिर दिव्य प्रबंधम्), about **4000** verses.

- 1 **Poigai** is an Alvar and one of the Mudal Alvars.
- 2 **Bhoothath** is an Alvar and one of the Mudal Alvars.
- 3 **Pey** is an Alvar and one of the Mudal Alvars.
- 4 **Thirumazhisai** is the fourth Alvar.
- 5 **Nammalvar** is the fifth Alvar. His work is *Tiruvaymoli*.
- 6 **Madhurakavi** is the sixth Alvar.
- 7 **Kulasekhara** is the seventh Alvar.
- 8 **Periyalvar** is the eighth Alvar. He is Andal's father.
- 9 **Andal** is the ninth Alvar. She is the only woman Alvar and wrote *Tiruppavai*.
- 10 **Thondaradipodi** is the tenth Alvar.
- 11 **Thiruppan** is the eleventh Alvar.
- 12 **Thirumangai** is the twelfth Alvar.

Nayanars

There are **63 Nayanars**. They are Shaiva poet-saints of Shiva. Their corpus is the *Tevaram* (तेवारम्) and the *Tiruvachakam*.

- The four **Samayacharyas** are **Appar**, **Sambandar**, **Sundarar**, and **Manikkavachakar**.
- Manikkavachakar authored the celebrated devotional work *Tiruvachakam*. While distinct in his historical placement, he is counted as one of the four principal Samayacharyas of Tamil Shaivism.
- **Karaikkal Ammaiyar** is the earliest woman Shaiva saint. Sundarar's *Tiruttondattogai* lists the 63.

Maharashtra Varkari

Deity: Vitthala of Pandharpur

- **Jnaneshwar** wrote *Jnaneshwari* (ज्ञानेश्वरी) / *Bhavartha Dipika* on the Gita (~**1290**).

- **Namdev** (नामदेव) composed abhangas. His hymns are also in the Guru Granth. He is the **earliest** of the 2025 four.
- **Eknath** wrote *Eknathi Bhagavat*.
- **Tukaram** (तुकाराम) composed **17th** c. abhangas.
- **Chokhamela** was a low-caste Varkari saint.

Ramananda

Kashi | Rama-bhakti open to all | Ramananda line

- His disciple **Kabir** (कबीर) was a weaver.
- His disciple **Ravidas** was a cobbler.
- His disciple **Dhanna** was a Jat.
- His disciple **Sena** was a barber.
- His disciple **Pipa** was the Rajput king of Gagaraun.
- His disciple **Sadhana** was a butcher.
- Other names in the traditional twelve are Anantananda, Sukhananda, Surasurananda, Padmavati, Narahari, and Bhavananda.

Kabir

Ramananda | Bijak | Maghar (Sant Kabir Nagar, Uttar Pradesh)

- Kabir is nirguna and a weaver. His Hindi *sabad* are also in the Guru Granth. He attacked idol and caste.

Ravidas

Ramananda | Varanasi

- Ravidas was a cobbler saint. His hymns are in the Guru Granth.

Guru Nanak (as bhakti figure)

1469–1539 | companion Mardana

- Nanak is nirguna and composed *Japji*. He founded the Sikh panth of ten Gurus, the last being **Gobind Singh**. He was born **before** Chaitanya (**1486**).

Surdas

Vallabhacharya | Braj | Sursagar

- Surdas is Krishna saguna. He is the blind poet of Krishna-lila.

Tulsidas

Awadhi | Ramcharitmanas

- Tulsidas is Rama saguna. *Ramcharitmanas* (रामचरितमानस) is **not Sanskrit**. He also wrote *Vinay Patrika*, *Kavitavali*, and *Hanuman Bahuk*.

Chaitanya Mahaprabhu

1486–1534 | Bengal | Gaudiya Krishna-bhakti

- Chaitanya practised kirtan / sankirtana. The Goswamis later settled at Vrindavan.

Other high-yield saints

- **Jayadeva** wrote *Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद) (**12th** c., Sanskrit).
- **Shankaradeva** belongs to Assam. He is linked with satra, namghar, *Kirtan Ghosa*, and Sattriya dance.
- **Narsinh Mehta** wrote in Gujarati. His hymn is *Vaishnava jana to*.
- **Basava / Akka Mahadevi** composed Kannada vachanas. They belong to Virashaiva / Lingayat.
- **Lal Ded** composed Kashmiri *vakh*.
- **Mirabai** (मीराबाई) belongs to Rajasthan. She composed Krishna bhajans.
- **Dadu Dayal** is nirguna and founded the Dadu-panth.
- **Samartha Ramdas** belongs to Maharashtra. He wrote *Dasbodh* and was the guru of Shivaji (not Guru Ram Das).
- **Tyagaraja** (त्यागराज) composed Telugu/Carnatic Rama kirtanas.
- **Daya Bai** wrote *Vinay Malika* and *Dayabodh* (Charandas).
- **Sahajo Bai** wrote *Sahaj Prakash* (Charandas).
- **Gangabai** is **not** the author of *Ganesh Dev Leela*.

The chronological sequence of leading Bhakti saints is: **Namdev → Kabir → Guru Nanak → Chaitanya Mahaprabhu**.

> **Logic:** Guru Granth has Kabir and Namdev, **not** Tulsidas.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q12

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I (Disciple) A. Kabir B. Amir Khusrau C. Surdas D. Mardana

List-II (Guru) 1. Guru Nanak Dev 2. Swami Ramananda 3. Nizamuddin Auliya 4. Vallabhacharya

A. 3 2 4 1 B. 3 2 1 4 C. 2 3 4 1 D. 2 3 1 4

Show answer

Ans: C — 2, 3, 4, 1.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q74

Arrange the following saints in the correct chronological order:

1. Guru Nanak
2. Chaitanya Mahaprabhu
3. Namdev

4. Kabir

A. 3, 4, 2, 1 B. 4, 3, 1, 2 C. 3, 4, 1, 2 D. 4, 3, 2, 1

Show answer

Ans: C — Namdev → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q39

Which of the following pairs (**Poetess — Composition**) is **not** correctly matched?

A. Daya Bai — Vinay Malika B. Sahajobai — Sahaj Prakash C. Gangabai — Ganesh Dev Leela D. Son Kumari — Poem of Swam Beli

Show answer

Ans: C.

2.6 Sufi Movement

Sufism is *tasawwuf*, Islamic mysticism. The path runs **sharia**, then **tariqa**, then **haqiqa**.

- Pir / murshid (पीर / मुर्शिद) is the teacher. Murid (मुरीद) is the disciple.
- Khanqah (ख़ानक़ाह) is a hospice. Dargah (दरगाह) is a tomb-shrine. Urs (उर्स) is the death anniversary.
- **Sama** (समा / महफ़िल-ए-समा) is a musical assembly. Related practices are zikr (ज़िक्र), fana (फ़ना), and baqa (बक़ा).
- **Wahdat-ul-wujud** (वहदत-उल-वुजूद - Ibn Arabi) is unity of being. **Wahdat-ul-shuhud** (वहदत-उश-शुहूद - **Ahmad Sirhindi**, Naqshbandi) is unity of witness.
- Traders arrived from the **8th–9th** c. Organised silsilas (सिलसिला) date from the **12th–13th** c.

Chishti order (चिश्ती सिलसिला)

Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti (d. 1236) | Ajmer Sharif

- The order was open to Hindus. It practised *futuh*/charity and **sama and qawwali**. The ideal was distance from the Sultan's gifts.
- **Muinuddin** is associated with Ajmer.
- **Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki** is associated with Mehrauli.
- **Baba Farid** is associated with Pakpattan. His hymns are in the **Guru Granth**.
- **Nizamuddin Auliya** is associated with Delhi (d. **1325**).
- **Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Dehli** is associated with Delhi.
- **Burhanuddin Gharib** is associated with Daulatabad.
- **Gesu Daraz (Bandanawaz / Hussaini)** is associated with Gulbarga.
- **Salim Chishti** is at **Fatehpur Sikri (UP)**. Akbar named Prince Salim after him.

Nizamuddin Auliya

Dargah: Nizamuddin, Delhi — **not Multan**

- His disciple was **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) (Tuti-e-Hind; qawwali tradition). Khusrau did **not** compile the malfuzat.
- *Fawaid-ul-Fawad* was compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi**.

Suhrawardi order

Multan | Bahauddin Zakariya

- The order was closer to the state and to Sharia. Uch is the other centre. Do not park Nizamuddin here.

Qadiri order

Origin: Abdul Qadir Jilani (Baghdad)

- The order later became widespread in Punjab and the Deccan. **Miyan Mir** (Lahore) is linked with the Golden Temple foundation tradition.

Naqshbandi order

Style: silent zikr; orthodox

- The Indian line runs **Baqi Billah**, then **Ahmad Sirhindi** (Mujaddid, wahdat-ul-shuhud), then Shah Waliullah.

Other silsilas

- The **Firdausi** order is linked with Sharafuddin Yahya Maneri at Bihar Sharif.
- The **Shattari** order is linked with Mandu and Bengal.

Sufi books

- **Kashf-ul-Mahjub** is by Ali Hujwiri (Data Ganj Bakhsh) of Lahore. It is the earliest Persian Sufi manual in India.
- **Fawaid-ul-Fawad** is by Hasan Sijzi.
- **Khair-ul-Majalis** is linked with Chiragh-i-Dehli.
- **Akhbar-ul-Akhyar** is by Abdul Haqq Dehlavi.
- Hatha yoga was practised by Nathpanthis. Some Sufis adopted the technique.
- Early Chishtis loved sama — that does **not** explain Persian translations of Sanskrit music treatises (2018 A/R: both true, R not explanation).

> **Logic:** Nizamuddin Auliya's dargah is in **Delhi**, not Multan. *Fawaid-ul-Fawad* was compiled by **Hasan Sijzi**, not Amir Khusrau.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q40

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Shaikh Moinuddin — Ajmer Chishti B. Shaikh Burhanuddin — Daulatabad Gharib C. Shaikh Mohammad — Gulbarga Hussaini D. Shaikh Nizamuddin — Multan Auliya

Show answer

Ans: D — Nizamuddin Auliya is Delhi.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q101

The book 'Fawaid ul Fawad' is the record of the conversations of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya, it was compiled by

A. Amir Hassan Sizzi B. Amir Khusro C. Ziauddin Barni D. Hasan Nizami

Show answer

Ans: A — Amir Hasan Sijzi.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q14

With reference to Hath Yog, which of the following statement is/are correct?

1. Hath Yog was practiced by Nathpanthis.
2. Hath Yog technique was also adopted by the Sufis.

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Show answer

Ans: C.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q90

Assertion (A): Many Sanskrit works on music were translated into Persian during the medieval period. Reason (R): The early Chishti sufis were fond of musical assemblies called, 'sama'.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A) B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Show answer

Ans: B.

2.7 Major Religious Traditions of India

Originated in India: Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism, Sikhism. **Arrived:** Islam, Christianity, Zoroastrianism, Judaism.

- Hinduism has no single founder. Its sources are the Vedas, smriti, epics, and Puranas.
- Buddhism and Jainism are Indian-origin. The Jain community has the **highest urban share**.

- Islam reached Kerala by trade from the **7th** c., then the Sultanate. Lucknow is a major **Shia** centre in UP.
- Christianity follows the **St. Thomas** tradition on the Kerala coast (**1st** c.). Later came Catholic Goa and Protestant missions. It did **not** originate in India.
- Parsis follow Zarathustra / Avesta. They landed at Sanjan from Persia (**8th–10th** c.). They use the agiary and the Tower of Silence.
- Jewish groups in India are Cochin, Bene Israel, and Baghdadi.
- Census **2011** band: Hindu ~**80%**, Muslim ~**14%**, Christian ~**2.3%**, Sikh ~**1.7%**, Buddhist ~**0.7%**, Jain ~**0.4%**.

Ten Sikh Gurus

- **1 Nanak (1469–1539)** taught Ik Onkar. He made four udasis. He is linked with Nankana Sahib.
- **2 Angad** developed **Gurmukhi**.
- **3 Amar Das** organised langar and the manji system. He opposed sati and purdah.
- **4 Ram Das** founded **Amritsar** (अमृतसर) (Ramdaspur).
- **5 Arjan** compiled the **Adi Granth** (**1604**). He is linked with Harmandir Sahib. He was the first Sikh Guru-martyr (Jahangir).
- **6 Hargobind** taught **Miri-Piri**. He raised the Akal Takht and wore two swords.
- **7 Har Rai** was the seventh Guru.
- **8 Harkrishan** was a child guru. He died at Delhi.
- **9 Tegh Bahadur** was martyred in **1675** at Delhi (Aurangzeb).
- **10 Gobind Singh** founded the **Khalsa** at Anandpur on **Vaisakhi 1699**. He prescribed the Five Ks. He ended personal Guruship and made the **Granth as Guru (1708)**.
- The Five Ks are kesh, kangha, kara, kachera, and kirpan.
- The Guru Granth includes Kabir, Namdev, Ravidas, and **Baba Farid**. It does not include Tulsidas.
- The Khalsa is Gobind Singh, **not** Nanak.
- **Akal Takht** is at Amritsar.
- **Takht Sri Keshgarh** is at Anandpur Sahib (Khalsa **1699**).
- **Takht Sri Damdama** is at Talwandi Sabo.
- **Takht Sri Patna Sahib** is at Patna (Gobind's birth).
- **Takht Sri Hazur Sahib** is at Nanded (Gobind's death, **1708**).

> **Logic:** Jain = most urbanised. Khalsa = 1699 Gobind Singh. Adi Granth = Arjan.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q96

Which religious group in India has its highest urban population?

A. Hindu B. Buddhist C. Christian D. Jain

Show answer

Ans: D — Jain.

2.8 Religious Beliefs and Cultural Heritage

Belief produces culture. Temple, stupa, mosque, and gurdwara are the built face of that belief.

- Hindu: temple, ghat, matha; Vedic chanting, Ramlila, Yoga, Kumbh, kirtan.
- Buddhist: stupa, chaitya, vihara; meditation, Jataka, Ladakh Buddhist chanting.
- Jain: hill tirtha, Gommateshwara; Paryushana, sallekhana.
- Islam/Sufi: mosque, dargah; qawwali, sama.
- Sikh: gurudwara, Akal Takht; kirtan, langar, Vaisakhi.
- Parsi: agiary; **Nowruz** (ICH).
- Granth hymns of Kabir, Namdev, Farid.
- Ajmer traffic. Miyan Mir and Golden Temple.
- Dara Shikoh *Majma-ul-Bahrain*. Awadh Ganga-Jamuni tehzeeb.
- Fatehpur Sikri / Salim Chishti.

Kumbh Mela

UNESCO: Intangible Cultural Heritage, **2017** (not a monument WH)

- Four sites: **Prayagraj** (प्रयागराज) (Ganga–Yamuna–Saraswati), Haridwar (Ganga), Nashik-Trimbak (Godavari), Ujjain (Shipra). Twelve-year cycle.
- **Maha Kumbh, Prayagraj, 13 Jan–26 Feb 2025** (~45 days).
- Qutub Minar and Taj Mahal are **tangible** World Heritage — not ICH.
- Vedic chanting UNESCO ICH **2008**.
- Ramlila UNESCO ICH **2008**.
- Yoga UNESCO ICH **2016**.
- Sankirtana (Manipur) UNESCO ICH **2013**.
- Ladakh Buddhist chanting UNESCO ICH **2012**.
- Ramman UNESCO ICH **2009**.
- Mudiyettu UNESCO ICH **2010**.
- Durga Puja Kolkata UNESCO ICH **2021**.

Sacred geography — UP vs not UP

UP: Sarnath, Kushinagar, Shravasti, Sankisa, Kaushambi; Kashi, Ayodhya, Mathura–Vrindavan, Prayagraj, Chitrakoot, Naimisharanya; Maghar (Kabir); Fatehpur Sikri (Salim Chishti). **Not UP:** Bodh Gaya, Pavapuri, Vaishali, Rajgir, Nalanda (**Bihar**); Lumbini (**Nepal**); Ajmer (**Rajasthan** (थार)); Amritsar (**Punjab**); Girnar/Palitana (**Gujarat**); Shravanabelagola (**Karnataka**); Sammed Shikhar (**Jharkhand**).

- Constitutional frame: Preamble secular (**42nd** Amendment). Arts. **25–28**.

> **Logic:** Kumbh = intangible **2017**, not a monument. Relic-worship built the **stupa** (स्तूप).